

Talent Scarcity Heatmap

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Where AI/MLOps skills cost most

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Talent Scarcity Heatmap maps where specialist AI, data and MLOps skills are most scarce and expensive, informing build-versus-buy, location and partnership decisions.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A workforce-planning construct drawing on labour-market analysis of AI skills, including OECD and industry skills studies.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to make the scarcity and cost of AI talent a visible input to strategy rather than an after-the-fact constraint.

FIGURE 1 · TALENT SCARCITY HEATMAP

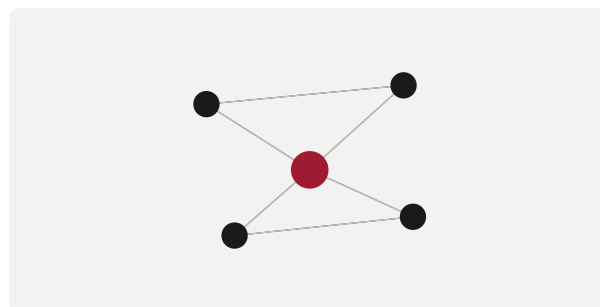


Figure 1. A schematic of the Talent Scarcity Heatmap as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Skills are shaded by scarcity and cost; the map informs whether to build internal capability, outsource, or partner, and where to locate teams.

WHEN IT IS USED

During AI workforce and sourcing strategy.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

HR, technology and transformation leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It elevates talent scarcity to a first-order strategic variable, recognising that the wage premium can dwarf software spend.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

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Make-vs-Buy Decision Tree · Slibrary 11

Skill-Premium Curve · Slibrary 11

MLOps Maturity Ladder · Slibrary 11

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

OECD (2023) OECD Employment Outlook 2023: Artificial Intelligence and the Labour Market. Paris: OECD.

Stanford HAI (2024) AI Index Report.